the content is consistent in promoting hostility towards non-Muslims, especially Hindus and a Hindu India, Christians and the British missionaries, and even Jews as the tormentors of Muslims.

This ideological intersection that reinforces a form of Islamic nationalism as the defining feature of the Pakistani identity has also been found in the textbooks published in 2014–15, 2015–16 and 2016–17, despite the commitment to reforming the curriculum. For example, the Punjab Curriculum and Textbook Board (PCTB) and the KP Textbook Board both include chapters on Muhammad Bin Qasim and Shah Wali Ullah in their Islamiyat textbooks for Grade 8, with the KP Islamiyat textbook highlighting the role of the Islamic scholar Shah Wali Ullah in laying the foundation of the 'two nation theory' in the Indian subcontinent that reinforced the notion that Hindus and Muslims were two separate entities ('Islamiyat' KP Textbook Board 2015–16a, p. 123).

English is another subject which is often overlooked in studies on identity in Pakistan. The PCTB is clear on its objectives of promoting an Islamic ideology even through English textbooks with most beginning with the saying 'In the Name of Allah, the most Gracious and Merciful' that appears either in the beginning of the Table of Contents or in the first chapter. Furthermore, the English textbooks for Grades 5, 8 and 10 begin with a chapter on the 'Prophet Muhammad (p.b.u.h.)'.[6] The reason for such Islam-centred content is related both to the PCTB's own focus on promoting Islamic ideology and to the influence of the Council of Islamic Ideology on curriculum and textbooks. All Urdu textbooks begin with a 'Hamd' – a piece written in praise of God, and a 'Naat' – a piece written in praise of the Prophet Muhammad (p.b.u.h.). The ideological connection between being Pakistani and Muslim is further reiterated through other narratives in the Urdu textbook. For example, the Urdu textbook for Grades 9–10 by the Punjab Textbook Board has a chapter explaining how to write a dialogue, where one of the examples includes a conversation between a student and teacher on the history of Pakistan that begins with the 'Islamic rule' of Muhammad Bin Qasim, and ends with Quaid-e-Azam defeating the combined forces of Hindus and the British to gain Pakistan (see p. 77, 'Urdu Quaid o Insha' Grades 9–10 2015–16).

The Urdu textbooks produced by the Sindh Textbook Board begin with either a 'Hamd' followed by a 'Naat' or a chapter describing the life of the Prophet Muhammad (p.b.u.h.), or includes them in the section on poems. The Urdu textbook for Grades 9 and 10 has chapters on prominent historical figures that were part of the Pakistan movement, including one chapter on 'Nazariya Pakistan' or the ideology of Pakistan which focuses again on Islamic ideology,